INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SAFETY EQUIPMENT, CLIMBING

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Federal Aviation Agency, Systems Research and Development Service, Environmental Development Division, Washington, D.C., 20553, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for safety climbing equipment procured by the Federal Government to be installed on structures such as buildings, towers, poles, etc.

1.1.1 Federal specification coverage. Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification. Safety climbing equipment shall be of the following type as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Rigid type carrier.
Type II - Flexible type carrier.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

QQ-P-416 - Plating, Cadmium (Electro-Deposited).
QQ-W-470 - Wire, Steel, High Carbon, Spring, Bright, Music.
CCC-C-467 - Cloth, Burlap, Jute (or Kenaf).
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

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(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Ft. Worth, Texas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Auburn, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-W-4088 - Webbing, Textile, Woven Nylon.
MIL-W-5665 - Webbing, Textile, Cotton Warp.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130 - Identification Marking of U. S. Military Property.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

American Society for Testing and Materials Standards:

A36 - Structural Steel.
A123 - Standard Specifications for Zinc (Hot-Galvanized) Coatings on Products Fabricated from Rolled, Pressed, and Forged Steel Shapes, Plates, Bars, and Strip.
A153 - Zinc Coating (Hot-Dip) on Iron and Steel Hardware.
A385 - Recommended Practice for Providing High Quality Zinc Coatings (Hot-Dip) on Assembled Products.
A475 - Zinc Coated Steel Wire Strand.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pa. 19103.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General. The safety climbing equipment furnished under this specification shall be for specific structure types and heights, as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.2), and shall include all components necessary for immediate and complete installation and use. The equipment shall include the following:

(a) Main support element (carrier and means of attaching the carrier to the structure on which it will be used, and cable guides when required).

(b) Slide or safety sleeve (the moving component with locking mechanism which makes the connection between the main structural support element and the safety belt).

(c) Safety belt.

(d) Lanyard, when specified (see 6.2).

3.2 Performance. The equipment shall be capable of the following operational features.

3.2.1 Operation. The equipment shall be of a type which can be operated entirely by the user. It shall permit the user to ascend or descend structures without having to manually manipulate or control any part of the safety equipment except as necessary to pass an intermediate support.

3.2.2 Length of fall. The maximum possible length of fall that may be sustained by a user shall be limited to not more than six inches of movement of the slide or safety sleeve.

3.2.3 Multiple users. The equipment shall allow at least two users, averaging 250 pounds each (including equipment), to ascend or descend simultaneously. Any movement of one user shall not have any effect on the actions or climbing ability of the other users.

3.2.4 Static load. The equipment shall be strong enough to support a minimum static load of 1000 pounds.

3.2.5 Impact load. The equipment shall be strong enough to absorb the impact load of a solid object weighing at least 500 pounds in a free fall of 12 inches. When a lanyard is furnished, the equipment shall also be strong enough to absorb an impact load of a solid object weighing at least 250 pounds in a free fall of six feet.

3.2.6 Readiness for use. No special equipment, instruments, or time consuming procedures shall be required to insure that the safety equipment is in a safe and operational condition or to determine that the safety equipment is safe and operational before each usage. The operation of the entire safety equipment shall not be affected by rain, mud, oil, or grease.

3.2.7 Signal interference. The safety equipment shall not interfere with any signal propogation characteristic of an antenna attached to the structure and shall not present an electrical hazard to the climber. All connections, including cable guides, shall be made so as to preclude intermittent contact between the equipment and the structure and between components of the equipment.

3.3 Materials. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the material for each component shall be as stated herein.

3.3.1 Dissimilar metals. In order to reduce galvanic action, contact between dissimilar metals shall be held to a minimum, including contacts between the equipment and the structure on which the equipment is to be installed. If contact between dissimilar metals cannot be avoided, metals close to one another in the electromotive force series shall be utilized.

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3.3.2 Factors of safety. The factor of safety of each component of equipment (except the lanyard) shall be based on the ultimate stress of the material and shall be not less than as stated below:

(a) Flexible components such as wire rope, webbing, and fabric shall have a safety factor of 10.

(b) Brittle material shall have a safety factor of 8.

(c) Ductile material shall have a safety factor of 5.

3.4 Protective finish. All steel components, not made of stainless steel or cadmium plated, shall be galvanized in accordance with ASTM A123, ASTM A153, or ASTM A385, as appropriate.

3.5 Mounting spacing.

3.5.1 Type I. For a rigid carrier, the spacing of the mountings along the entire length of the carrier shall be in accordance with the manufacturer's recommendation and shall include at splices, one mounting installed as close as practicable to each splice in the carrier.

3.5.2 Type II. Flexible carriers shall be mounted to the structure at each end of the carrier. Cable guides utilized with a flexible carrier shall be installed at a minimum spacing of 25 feet and a maximum spacing of 40 feet along the entire length of the carrier.

3.6 Detail requirements.

3.6.1 Main support element. The main support element shall consist of the carrier and mountings (including cable guides, fasteners, washers, etc.) for attaching the carrier to the structure. The design and construction of the main support element shall be such that no connection of the installation can be loosened by vibrations set up by wind forces. The means used to attach the carrier to the ladder or structure shall be capable of adaption to ladder rungs, poles, or structural shapes, as specified in the invitation for bid. The mountings shall be of ASTM A36 steel, or equal. Any loads transmitted into the structure through the mountings shall be such that the structural integrity of any of the connected parts, including ladder legs, rungs, towers, etc. is not altered. The configuration of the carrier and the action of the holding mechanism shall be such that the efficiency of the safety climbing equipment is not reduced by chipping, wearing, fretting, or linking. Where the ladder or vertical structure terminates at a platform, the main support element shall extend 4 feet - 6 inches above the top of the platform. The size of the carrier and mountings shall be such that there is a minimum of six (6) inches of foot space on each side of the carrier.

3.6.1.1 Type I carrier. When a rigid carrier is furnished, it shall be a component such as a tube, I-beam, H-beam, or angular in cross section and shall have notches, serrations, or other means of stopping and holding the fall of a user. Where the carrier is not in one piece, each joint of the carrier shall be dowelled or prefabricated with a connection which can easily be fastened together during erection and which will maintain an accurate alignment of the parts at the joint and provide smooth and free passage of the slide or sleeve over the joint. The connection shall allow passage of the slide or sleeve without the user having to manipulate the sleeve or disconnect the safety snap. The load carrying capacity of the carrier connection shall be equal to the load carrying capacity of the carrier section. The joint shall not interfere with or interrupt the passage of the sleeve in either direction. The carrier shall be galvanized steel or stainless steel or aluminum alloy.

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3.6.1.2 Type II carrier. When a flexible carrier is furnished, it shall be preformed stainless steel alloy or zinc-coated steel wire rope with a steel wire center and shall have a minimum breaking strength of 10,000 pounds. When zinc-coated steel wire rope is used, the weight of the zinc-coating shall be equal to Class C of ASTM A475. The wire rope shall be in one piece between the bottom mounting and the top mounting. The design of the carrier, mountings, and intermediate guides shall be such that a force of 20 pounds applied normal to the carrier at the mid-point between guides, shall not cause a deflection of more than 2 inches from the normal installed position.

3.6.1.2.1 Cable guides. The design of the cable guides shall be such that the user can easily disengage the carrier from, and reengage the carrier to the guide with one hand.

3.6.2 Slide or safety sleeve. The safety equipment shall include provisions for positively attaching a safety belt to a slide or safety sleeve. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), two slides or safety sleeves shall be furnished with each complete safety equipment. The safety sleeve body shall be made from a noncorrosive material such as stainless steel, manganese bronze, aluminum alloy, or other suitable material capable of being fabricated into a light and compact component capable of withstanding the imposed load without detrimental deflections. A locking mechanism shall be connected to the safety sleeve by means of a corrosion resistant steel pin and shall be spring actuated by a cadmium plated spring or springs made of steel conforming to Federal Specification QQ-W-470. The locking mechanism shall positively lock the safety sleeve to the carrier when load is applied in any but a normal ladder climing position. When bearings are required, they shall be lifetime lubricated and sealed or provisions shall be made for maintenance lubrication. When the carrier is to be erected on curved structures, the sleeve may be hinged or be in two or more parts in order to be capable of traveling over angles and curves on the carrier. The construction of the sleeve and locking mechanism shall be such that the sleeve will not move down the carrier more than 6 inches when the user disconnects from it at any point along the carrier. The sleeve shall be clearly and permanently marked to indicate the correct direction of installation and shall be removable at the top and the bottom of the carrier. The safety snap or snaps and any connecting links used to connect the safety belt to the sleeve, shall be of drop-forged steel. All safety snaps shall have a double locking action which will prevent opening of the snap when a load is applied in any direction. When more than one safety snap is used, the top snap shall control the action of the locking mechanism. All snaps and links shall be cadmium plated in accordance with Federal Specification QQ-P-416, Type I, Class I.

3.6.2.1 Stopping mechanism. The mechanism in the slide or safety sleeve for preventing falling of using personnel shall be simple in mechanical operation with all levers, cams, hooks, and breaks easily viewable for inspection. The assembly shall be designed so as to prevent tampering or any parts being frozen in such a position as to be ineffective.

3.6.3 Safety belts. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), two safety belts shall be furnished with each complete safety equipment.

3.6.3.1 Fabrication and materials. The safety belt or harness shall be fabricated in accordance with the following paragraphs. The materials used for the body strap webbing and the body pad webbing shall be in accordance with MIL-W-4088 and MIL-W-5665 respectively. No part of the load carrying components of the safety belt body strap shall be made of leather.

3.6.3.2 Body pad. The body pad shall have at least the construction and physical properties of Type IV, Class 1B webbing of MIL-W-5665. The function of the body pad is to provide comfort to the wearer and protect against slipout hazard during emergencies. The body pad shall be fastened to the body strap by riveting, stitching, or combination capable of holding the two together during emergencies of the climber. The body pad and its component parts shall be treated to resist moisture and fungus. All points of wear shall be reinforced.

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3.6.3.3 Body strap. The body strap shall conform to Type XIII webbing of MIL-W-4088. All fastenings shall be stitched and riveted using handset copper rivets. All points of wear shall be re-inforced. The belt ends shall be heat sealed or woven to prevent unraveling.

3.6.3.4 Hardware. The safety belt shall be fitted with the following hardware:

3.6.3.4.1 Connector. Each safety belt shall be equipped with a connector, by means of which the slide or safety sleeve can be attached to the belt. Unless the design of the equipment is such that a special connector is necessary, a D-ring as described in 3.6.3.4.2 shall be used for this purpose. When a special connector is necessary, it shall be equal in load carrying capability to the D-ring described in 3.6.3.4.2.

3.6.3.4.2 "D" ring. The "D" ring shall be 3/8 inch minimum cold rolled or drop-forged steel with a minimum tensile proof load of 1250 pounds. The "D" ring shall accommodate the snap hook of the safety lanyard or safety clamp. Two additional "D" rings shall be furnished on each safety belt for attaching tools, etc. The "D" ring on the right hand side of the belt shall have a safety snap hook attached to it.

3.6.3.4.3 Buckle. The buckle shall be drop-forged mild steel with a drop-forged tongue and a sheet steel roller. The buckle shall be capable of withstanding a 1500 pound pull test with a 1/64 inch maximum deformation in any direction.

3.6.4 Lanyard. When specified (see 6.2), a lanyard shall be furnished with each safety belt. The lanyard shall be a nylon rope 6 feet in length, with a minimum tensile strength of 6200 pounds and a minimum stretch (elongation) of 25 percent under 70 percent of the breaking load. The lanyard shall be completely assembled with standard size thimbles, double locking safety snaps at both ends, and a double ring buckle, or equal, at one end of the lanyard. The double ring buckle shall provide quick and easy length adjustment of the lanyard down to one half of the lanyard's length. The length adjustment buckle shall be capable of holding the lanyard at the desired length under emergency loading conditions, including impact, without slipping. The lanyard shall be treated to resist deterioration from weather and ultraviolet light. All hardware shall be cold-rolled or drop-forged steel with a minimum tensile strength of 5,000 pounds.

3.7 Marking.

3.7.1 Civil agency procurements. For civil agency procurements, the items covered by this specification shall be marked for identification in accordance with the manufacturer's standard practice. Marking shall include the manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.7.2 Military procurements. For military procurements, the items covered by this specification shall be marked for identification in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.8 Manuals.

3.8.1 Instruction manual. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish one copy of an instruction manual giving instructions for installation, operation, and maintenance of the items of equipment covered by this specification. Suggestions for deicing the equipment shall be included in the instructions.

3.8.2 Parts list. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish one copy of a parts list giving the number or designation of each part. The parts list may be included in the instruction manual specified in 3.8.1.

3.9 Workmanship. The items of equipment covered by this specification shall be free from defects affecting appearance or serviceability. The equipment shall be free from sharp edges, slivers, and burrs.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements, as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection of components and materials. In accordance with 4.1, the contractor is responsible for insuring that all components and materials used were manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified herein or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2 Sampling procedures. Sampling for testing and visual examination shall consist of the random selection of one complete safety equipment from each lot.

4.2.1 Lot. A lot shall consist of all safety climbing equipments of the same type offered for acceptance at one time, plus one complete equipment to be used for testing.

4.3 Visual examination. Each component of the equipment shall be examined for any nonconformance in design, material, finish, construction, workmanship, and marking. Any equipment with a defect affecting serviceability, or any equipment with more than five defects not affecting serviceability shall be considered defective and shall be cause for rejection of the entire lot.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Certification. When specified (see 6.2), the procuring office may accept in lieu of testing, the manufacturer's certification that the equipment being furnished meets or exceeds all of the test requirements of this specification.

4.4.2 Testing of complete equipment. Each complete equipment selected for testing shall be tested for conformance with 3.1 through 3.7. Any complete unit failing to meet any of the following tests shall be considered defective and shall be cause for rejection of the entire lot.

4.4.2.1 Test procedures. The equipment to be tested shall be installed on a structure similar to the type on which it was designed to be mounted and subjected to the following tests. When the complete equipment exceeds 40 feet in heighth, the portion to be tested need not exceed 40 feet.

4.4.2.1.1 Operational test. One person shall ascend and descend the structure (on which the equipment being tested is installed) using the sliding sleeve to visually determine that the locking device is properly working and that the sliding sleeve rides freely on the carrier. without any manipulation being required on the part of the climber, except as necessary to pass an intermediate support. After completion of the foregoing, one person and equipment totaling 250 pounds shall ascend and descend the structure. Successful completion of one person ascending and descending shall be followed by simultaneous ascending of two climbers with equipment, each totaling 250 pounds.

4.4.2.1.2 Static load test. The slide or safety sleeve shall be positioned midway between two support mountings or cable guides and a downward static load of 1000 pounds applied.

4.4.2.1.3 Fall tests. Fall tests shall be conducted to test the ability of the equipment to withstand impact loads. A solid object not less than 12 inches in diameter and weighing 500 pounds shall be secured in a safety belt, and the belt attached to the slide or safety sleeve. The slide or safety sleeve shall be positioned midway between two support mountings or cable guides with the locking mechanism not engaged. The load shall be raised and then allowed to drop a distance of 12 inches. Failure of the equipment to stop and hold the load, with a maximum movement of the slide or safety sleeve of six inches, shall constitute failure of this test and rejection of the entire lot. When a lanyard is furnished with the equipment, a second fall test shall be conducted as above except that the lanyard shall connect the safety belt to the slide or safety sleeve, and the load shall be 250 pounds in a free fall of six feet.

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4.4.3 Testing of components. The components of the flexible carrier, the safety belt, and the lanyard shall be tested for conformance to 3.6.1.2, 3.6.3.4.1, 3.6.3.4.2, 3.6.3.4.3 and 3.6.4 by normal test procedures. Any component not meeting the specified requirement shall be considered defective and shall be cause for rejection of the entire lot.

4.5 Examination after testing. After completion of each of the above tests, the equipment and all components shall be visually examined for cracks, deformation. chipping, or excessive wear or improper operation. Any defects noted during tests and determined by the inspector to be hazardous shall be sufficient reason to cease testing thereby causing the rejection of the entire lot. Complete equipments or components subjected to and passing the above tests shall not be returned to the lot for acceptance.

4.6 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table I. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery and selected at random just prior to the closing operation. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table I. Classification of preparation for delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling or distortion of container.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Sliding sleeve and hardware. The sliding sleeve shall be inserted in a polyethylene bag. The bag shall be closed or sealed. The hardware and sliding sleeve shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Cushioning and blocking shall be provided. The box shall be closed with tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.1.2 Safety belt. The safety belt shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed with tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.1.3 Lanyard. When provided, the lanyard coiled to the minimum diameter shall be packaged in accordance with method IC-1 of MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.4 Carrier. The ends of each carrier shall be wrapped with cloth conforming to CCC-C-467 and secured with wire.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Sliding sleeve and hardware. The sliding sleeve shall be inserted in a polyethylene bag. The bag shall be closed or sealed. The hardware and sliding sleeve shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Cushioning and blocking shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

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5.1.2.2 Safety belt. The safety belt shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the box specification.

5.1.2.3 Lanyard. When provided, the lanyard coiled to the minimum diameter shall be packaged in a kraft paper bag secured with staples or tape.

5.1.2.4 Carrier. The ends of each carrier shall be wrapped with cloth conforming to CCC-C-467 and secured with wire.

5.1.3 Level C. The safety equipment shall be packaged to afford protection against corrosion and damage during shipment from the supplier to the initial destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. The complete system shall be packed in a close-fitting wood box meeting the requirements of PPP-B-601, overseas type or PPP-B-621, class 2. Blocking and bracing shall be provided. The box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification. When the gross weight exceeds 250 pounds, skids shall be provided in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. The complete system shall be packed in a close-fitting wood box meeting the requirements of PPP-B-601, domestic type, or PPP-B-621, class 1. Blocking and bracing shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification. When the gross weight exceeds 250 pounds skids shall be provided in accordance with the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The complete system shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order (see 6.2), the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order (see 6.2), the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The safety climbing equipment covered by this specification is intended for both interior and exterior use where there are hazards involved to personnel in climbing ladders, poles, masts, and other elevated structures.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type of carrier required (see 1.2).
(c) Height, radius, and type of structure for which designed (see 3.1 and 6.3).
(d) When a lanyard is required (see 3.1).
(e) Material, when different (see 3.3).
(f) Quantity of slides or safety sleeves to be furnished, when different (see 3.6.2).
(g) Quantity of safety belts to be furnished, when different (see 3.6.3).
(h) Quantity of instruction manuals required, if different (see 3.8.1).
(i) Quantity of parts lists required, if different (see 3.8.2).
(j) When the contractor shall certify in lieu of testing that safety equipments meet specification requirements (see 4.4.1).
(k) Level of packaging required (see 5.1).
(l) Level of packing required (see 5.2).
(m) Special markings when required (see 5.3.1 and 5.3.2).

6.3 Curved and angular climbs. When the safety climb equipment is to be used for structures requiring the climber to move over curved surfaces or in angular directions, the invitation for bids shall indicate the radius required. It is recommended, however, that radii of less than 4 feet be avoided when possible, unless consideration be given to the methods the climber can use to negotiate sharp changes in directions (see 3.1).

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